Kerala pays more for vegetables, and pays later

Wholesale tomato, onion and potato prices, Jan 2021 to May 2026. Agmarknet via India Data Portal.

Crop

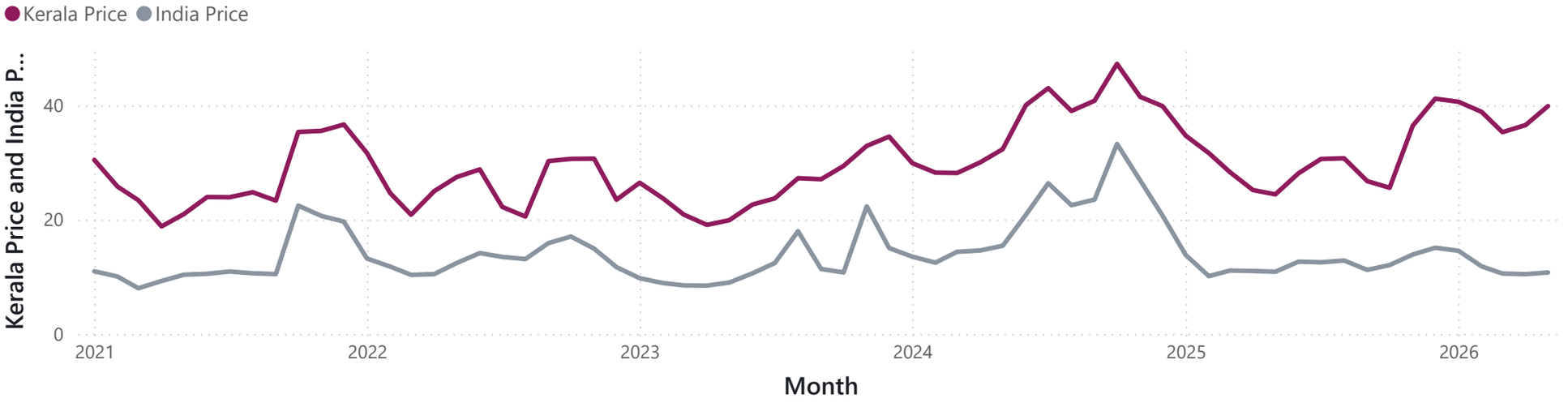
- [ ] Onion
- [ ] Potato
- [ ] Tomato

Year

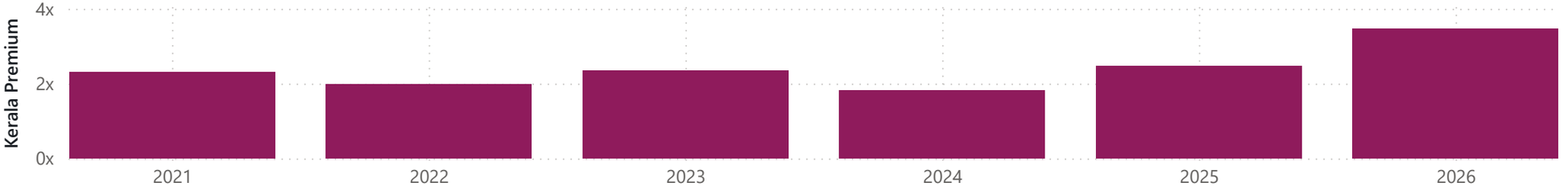
- [ ] 2020
- [ ] 2021
- [ ] 2022
- [ ] 2023
- [ ] 2024
- [ ] 2025
- [ ] 2026

29.0	12.7	2.3x	28
Kerala Price	India Price	Kerala Premium	Spikes

Median wholesale price by month, Rs/kg



Kerala pays, multiple of the all-India median, by year



Nearby Kerala markets price the same crop very differently

Each market's average monthly median price, and its gap to the median Kerala market.

Crop

- [ ] Onion
- [ ] Potato
- [ ] Tomato

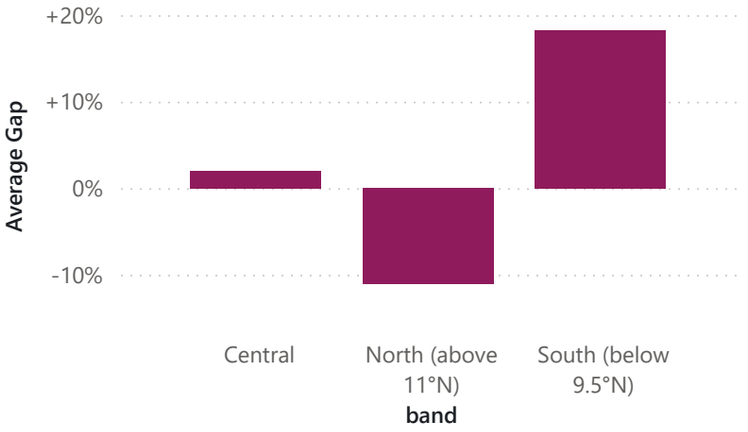
Region band

- [ ] Central
- [ ] North (above 11°N)
- [ ] South (below 9.5°...

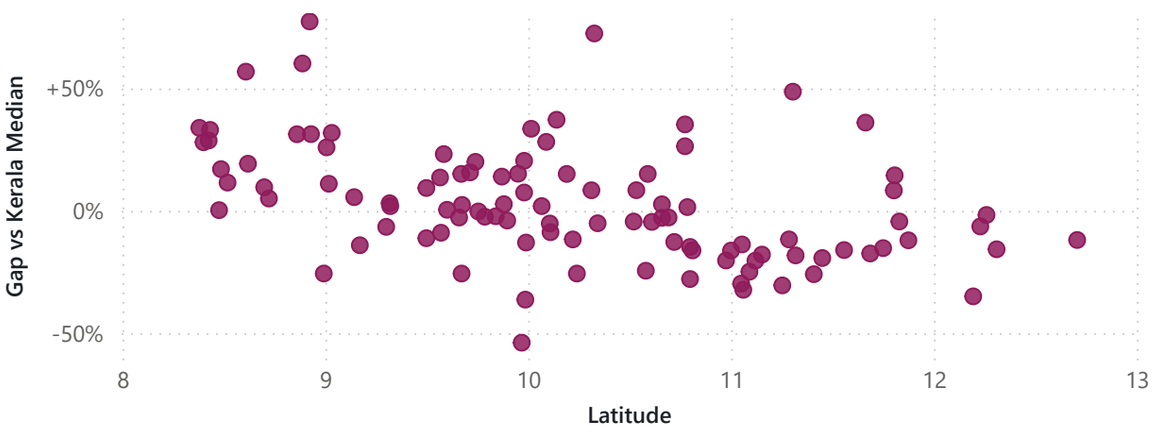
Year

- [ ] 2020
- [ ] 2021
- [ ] 2022
- [ ] 2023
- [ ] 2024
- [ ] 2025
- [ ] 2026

Average gap to the Kerala median, by region



Gap vs latitude: the north is cheaper



Markets

Market	District	Region band	Price, Rs/kg	Gap vs Kerala median
Anchal VFPCK	Kollam	South (below 9.5°N)	59.7	+77%
VELOORKKARA VFPCK	Thrissur	Central	58.0	+72%
Kollam	Kollam	South (below 9.5°N)	53.9	+60%
Nedumangadu	Thiruvananthapuram	South (below 9.5°N)	52.8	+57%
Kunnamangalam VFPCK	Kozhikode	North (above 11°N)	50.0	+49%
North Paravur	Ernakulam	Central	46.1	+37%
Sulthanbathery VFPCK	Wayanad	North (above 11°N)	45.8	+36%
Puthupariyaram VFPCK	Palakkad	Central	45.5	+35%
Parassala	Thiruvananthapuram	South (below 9.5°N)	45.0	+34%
Adimali	Idukki	Central	44.9	+34%
Neyyattinkara VFPCK	Thiruvananthapuram	South (below 9.5°N)	44.8	+33%
Sasthamkotta	Kollam	South (below 9.5°N)	44.3	+32%
Total			**33.7**	**+0%**

Spikes start at the hubs, about two weeks earlier

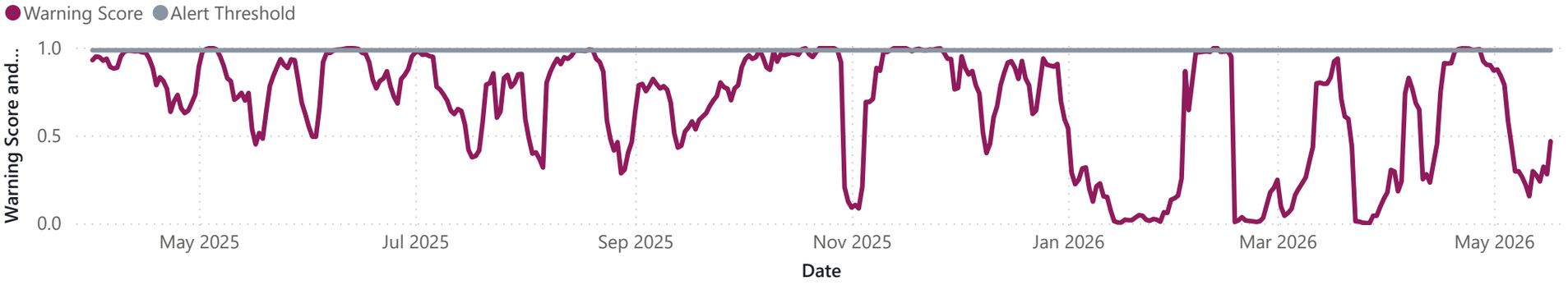
A spike: Kerala's price 30%+ higher 14 days later. The warning model was scored on Apr 2025 to May 2026, data it never saw.

Crop

- [ ] Onion
- [ ] Potato
- [ ] Tomato

28	22	14.5	32%	29%
Spikes	Hub Spiked First	Median Hub Lead Days	Precision	Recall

Highest warning score among the selected crops vs the alert threshold, test period



Spike events since 2021

Crop	Kerala start	Peak	Rise %	Hub lead (days)
Tomato	2026-04-22	2026-05-06	33.2	30
Tomato	2025-10-30	2025-11-29	135.5	1
Onion	2025-10-16	2025-11-09	64.5	7
Tomato	2025-07-18	2025-08-03	51.6	28
Tomato	2025-05-26	2025-06-13	42.5	4
Tomato	2024-11-16	2024-12-07	78.7	-3
Tomato	2024-08-31	2024-10-07	156.8	-1
Tomato	2024-06-04	2024-06-23	60.8	25
Onion	2024-05-29	2024-06-17	32.5	11

Approaches compared on the test period (chance PR-AUC = 0.04)

Approach	Type	PR-AUC	Precision	Recall
logistic | market+weather	Model	0.33	0.32	0.29
gradient_boosting | market+weather	Model	0.23	0.67	0.12
logistic | market+weather+news	Model	0.21	0.27	0.22
logistic | market	Model	0.17	0.15	0.12
gradient_boosting | market	Model	0.14	0.18	0.16
gradient_boosting | market+weather+news	Model	0.13	0.29	0.10
Hub price rising (14-day momentum)	Trader rule	0.10	0.17	0.18
Kerala price already rising (7-day momentum)	Trader rule	0.09	0.16	0.25